Walking with God

Walking with God materials adapted for Millheim instruction; existing source-course credits retained.

Full teaching files

millheim walking with God student	*38 pages*
millheim walking with God teacher	*38 pages*
pdf millheim walking with God teacher	*3 pages*
week 1 student	*3 pages*

Teacher and student editions are components of this one portfolio entry.

WALKING WITH GOD



MBC – "Next Steps" Bible Study

The Goal of this Series

To teach the Bible Believer the basics of his past, present, and future relationship to Jesus Christ *in order to have victory over sin and bring glory to God on a daily basis*.

Some of the issues we will deal with in this series are as follows:

1. The nature and condition of mankind
2. The enemies of a Believer and the ensuing warfare that is encountered
3. Living a life of Victory
4. Justification and sanctification
5. Spiritual development and reproduction

Key Text: Galatians 5:25

Galatians 5:25 - *"If we **live** in the Spirit, let us also **walk** in the Spirit."*

Week 1

Introduction

1. The Spiritual Christian

Our salvation introduced us to an intense struggle for true, biblical spirituality. A battle now exists between our flesh and our spirit *(Galatians 5:17)*.

KEY This battle ***cannot be won*** by suppressing the desires of the flesh through our own willpower.

Yet, God made us to have _____ over the flesh. Unfortunately, many believers seem to be losing that battle. As in any warfare there must be an equipping with the proper weapons, accompanied by ample training to use them.

We will seek to accomplish this "equipping and training" in order to achieve the overall goal of this series.

As we begin our study, let's consider some Biblical facts about our relationship with God:

a. We must allow God's truth to _____ us, not merely inform us – Philippians 4:9; James 1:21-25

NOTE *Informed* = Learned, Received, Heard, Seen

Transformed = _____ in form…*and the God of peace shall be with you.*

b. Spirituality is not determined by what we do for God, but rather, it is who we are _____ God – Genesis 3:8, 5:21-24; Hebrews 11:5

NOTE A real, truly Biblical Christian is one who doesn't just do all the right things, but one who knows God! Superficiality breaks down eventually. One who is truly spiritual is changed from deep within and it then works its way out!

c. True Biblical spirituality is determined by our _____ to know God and to have an intimate relationship with Him – Mark 14:18-19; John 13:21-25; Luke 10:38-42; Philippians 3:8-10; James 4:8

NOTE Knowing God is what this is all about…

d. The desire to know Him was placed in our hearts at salvation and is made operative by the _____ _____– Romans 8:15; Galatians 4:6

NOTE The Holy Spirit lives inside of us. You can't get more intimate than that! Yet, we don't often think of it in these terms.

e. It is possible to quench and _____ the working of God's Spirit within us – 1 Thessalonians 5:19; Ephesians 4:30 (25-30)

NOTE Because He is so close to us…because He is Holy…our sin and our apathy hurts Him!

f. Walking by faith and not by sight ... becoming a Biblically spiritual Christian is a _____ – Hebrews 11:25 (23-26); Daniel 3:16-18

NOTE At some point in our Christian life, we must wake up to the realization that we make ***critical choices daily*** for God's glory or for our own.

Week 2

2. The Nature and Condition of Man

a. The Beginning – The Creation of Man **(OUR PAST)**

- Man was originally made in God's **IMAGE** *(before the fall)* – Genesis 1:27

God – Gen. 1:26; 1 John 5:7; John 1:1-2, 14; Gen. 1:1-3

1 - Father
2 - Son *(Word)*
3 - Holy Spirit

Man – Gen. 2:7; 1 Thess. 5:23; Heb. 4:12

1 - Soul – (Father)
2 - Body – (Son)
3 - Spirit – (Holy Spirit)

KEY *Man's* **SOUL** *is not necessarily visible to the naked eye but includes a person's character, uniqueness, and giftedness. It is comprised of such elements as the mind, the will, and the emotions (God gave man the ability to exercise his own free will as seen by the insertion of the "tree of the knowledge of good and evil" in Genesis).*

Man's **BODY** *is what the Bible calls* ***the flesh****.*

Man's **SPIRIT** *is what the Bible calls the* ***inner man****, a part of man designed by God to be strengthened/empowered by close, personal, "spiritual" fellowship with God through the Spirit of God (Eph. 3:16).*

b. The Problem – The Fall of Man

KEY This is very important and why we have problems.

- Man **DISOBEYED** God – Gen. 2:16-17; 3:1-6
- Man's **spiritual** part died immediately upon sinning – Gen. 3:8
- Man's **physical** body now ages and eventually **DIES** – Gen. 5:5
- As a result of his **spiritual** and **physical** condition, man's **soul** also suffers a slow decay – Gen. 3:17-19; Ps. 90:10

- Man's children are now born in his own image, not in the image of God – Gen. 5:1-3; Rom. 5:12, 14-19

Important Considerations:

*We **do not cease to exist** at death, but our soul separates from our bodies, from this world, and potentially from God forever (aka… "give up the ghost" – Gen. 25:8, 17; John 19:30; Acts 5:5). This same type of separation is seen as Adam immediately becomes estranged from God, unable to have* **FELLOWSHIP** *with Him until God reveals His redemptive plan.*

This is the spiritually dead condition of every man and woman at birth. This is where all of our troubles began.

We often refer to lost man as being a TWO *part being. This is only true in the sense that man's spirit is dead (unable to fellowship with God). Lost man is still a* THREE *part being with a body (#1), a soul (#2), and a* **DEAD** *spirit in relation to God (#3).*

c. Saved Man **(OUR PRESENT)**

- As the result of Jesus substitutionary death, burial, and bodily resurrection *(the gospel*), all who trust in Christ's finished work now have the image of God restored. When we believe the gospel we are "born again" and our once "dead" spirit is brought back to life *(fellowship is restored with God)*.

  - His Spirit makes **our spirit** alive, or quickened – Eph. 2:1; Rom. 8:16; 1 Co. 2:11; 6:16; Col 2:11-12

  - **Our soul** is now able to **CHOOSE** to meditate on life – Psalm 19:7; 23:3; 42:2...or death – Jud.16:16; 2 Pet. 2:8

  - **Our dying body** is still in this world – Rom. 7:23-24, but it is powerless over us – Ro. 6:6-9 and scheduled to be replaced – Php. 3:21

d. Glorified Man **(OUR FUTURE)**

- When we were born again, **our spirit** was made alive and joined to His Spirit, **our soul** was given the ability to be renewed by His Word and we were given the promise of **a new body**. When we see Him we shall be **LIKE** Him, for we shall see Him as He really

is in the fullness of all of His glory – 1 John 3:2; Rom. 8:29-31

- The Holy Spirit and His working in our lives was meant to be the **DOWN** payment, or earnest of our promised glorious inheritance – 2 Co. 1:22; 5:5; Eph. 1:13-14. This is the reason why we should so "earnestly" seek to be **filled with** and **walk after** His Spirit.

- Our born-again, Spirit-filled lives are God's manifestation to the **physical world**, and the **UNSEEN** **supernatural world** of God's eternal plan, wisdom, and glory – Col. 1:27; Eph 3:10-11, 21

KEY He designed us when reborn to display ***His glory*** in and through us to all…as fallen, yet **RESTORED** creations of God!

That is what our mission is…

That is our purpose as individuals…

That is our purpose as a group of believers (church)…

This information should change how we view everything about our lives!!!

Week 3

3. The Warfare of a Christian – The Flesh vs the Spirit

a. The nature of this warfare – Galatians 5:17; Romans 7:21-25; Matthew 26:41

- We face three enemies as born again Bible Believers

1 - The **WORLD** – John 17:10, 12-15; James 4:4

2 - The **FLESH** – Romans 7:24

3 - The **DEVIL** – 1 Peter 5:8; Luke 22:31-32

NOTE God's Spirit in union with our spirit is in a battle with these 3 enemies:

- All three enemies have already been defeated! (Good news!)

1 - The world is defeated by the **WORD** – 1 John 5:4-5; Romans 10:17

2 - The flesh is defeated by the **WORD** – Psalm 119:9-11; Romans 12:1-2

3 - The devil is defeated by the **WORD** – 1 John 2:12-14; Eph. 6:10-17

NOTE They are already defeated in that we have the competed Word of God!

- Winning or losing this warfare is our **CHOICE**!

NOTE Remember…faith is a choice. Heb 11:25

b. The nature of the flesh

- The flesh is defiled, corrupted, and rotten – 2 Peter 2:10-22; Rom 7:18

KEY The real problem is authority, who is in control: God or **SELF**? Remember the definition of the "Kingdom of God"…Jesus ***rules*** from the inside!

Consider what the Bible says about the flesh…

- It is **WEAK** toward God – Matthew 26:41

- It cannot please God – Romans 8:8

- It will **KILL** you – Romans 8:6,13

NOTE This is true both physically and spiritually (eternally).

- It cannot inherit God's kingdom – Romans 8:23; I Cor 15:50

- It seeks to persecute the Spirit – Galatians 4:29; 5:17

NOTE Ishmael was the ***natural*** son of a carnal choice. Isaac was the ***supernatural*** son of a work completed by God.

c. The works of the flesh

Text – Galatians 5:19-21

- Sins which defile the body:

  - Adultery – being **UNFAITHFUL** to your spouse or spiritual adultery.

    NOTE The strange woman...Proverbs 5…Rev 17:5…

  - Fornication – any sexual sin outside of the marriage covenant.

  - Uncleanness – any pollution or impurity of the flesh starting with a dirty, lustful mind.

    NOTE Generally, this applies to sexual sin, but it also refers to "dirty"…

  - Lasciviousness – lewd and **LOOSE** behavior, uncontrolled sensual (alluring; carnal; erotic; lustful; provocative;

sexual) desire.

- Communion with Satanic forces:
  - Idolatry – anything **BETWEEN** me and God.
  - Witchcraft – use of satanic power, occult activity (and rebellion) - I Sam 15:23. Also associated with drug use (witchcraft = ***pharmakeia*** in Greek)

- Pride (ungodly love of self) – the root of ***all*** sin:
  - Hatred – internal hostile feelings.
  - Variance – quarreling, **CONTENTION**.
  - Emulations – jealousy and envy of others. Trying to be superior.
  - Wrath – **ACTING** on anger/hatred…can be in the form of violence.
  - Strife – surrounded in controversy; causing division and factions

- Religion and its fruits:
  - Sedition – uprising against God-ordained authorities
  - Heresies – denying essential **BIBLE** truth/doctrine
  - Envyings – not satisfied, wanting what others have in the way of position, power, or persons.
  - Murders – to **KILL** another through literal or verbal means – James 4:1-3

  NOTE Verbal includes breaking someone's spirit creating deep, life-long, emotional scars…

- General vices:
  - Drunkenness – anything that **CONTROLS** your life.
  - Revellings – wild partying; disorderly, outlandish behavior
  - Such like – not just the law, but the spirit of the principles

of God

KEY The issue is not what is wrong with it, but rather what is right about it!

Week 4

- <u>The works of the flesh in a Christian's life…</u>

- All of the items from God's "flesh list" are a potential threat inside of us.

NOTE It is not the **DEVIL**, it is my flesh. We do have a very real enemy…but we can't blame the devil for our fleshly desires!

- The works of the flesh are activated OR deactivated by our yielding:

To the *<u>flesh</u>* …OR

To *<u>the Spirit</u>*.

KEY This is the key to walking with God!!!! – Ro. 6:13, 19; Gal. 5:16

- We must not **LET** the works of the flesh reign – Ro. 6:12

NOTE Are you a slave to our own lusts? If so, you are a freed slave.

Your Master has purchased you…you are free now…to serve Him and to bring glory to Him **right now** – John 8:36; Gal. 4:9!

- Romans 8:8 - *"So then they that are in the flesh **CANNOT** please God."* The biblical reality is that nothing accomplished in my Christian life, done in my flesh alone, is pleasing to God.

- Winning or losing this warfare is my **CHOICE**...

NOTE God allows us a free will, even after salvation, to

choose right from wrong.

Josh. 1:5-9; 24:15

a. Sin and self – Understanding the enemy that resides **INSIDE** of us!

- The Christian's relationship to sin:
  - My sin was dealt with on the cross – Ro. 6:6-7; Gal. 2:20; Col. 2:13-14.
  - I am **DEAD** to sin – Ro. 6:2

    NOTE It ceased to have power over my eternity the moment I was saved!
  - Sin **CANNOT** control me – Ro. 6:14
  - I sin because I **CHOOSE** to sin – James 1:14

    KEY *If uncontested, sin can **again** become a way of life* (*like we did when we were lost!)*

    We ***must*** do what Daniel did…Dan. 1:8.
- The Christian's relationship to self:
  - It is possible to do biblical things in the power of the flesh – Php. 1:16-18

    EXAMPLE Satan tempted Eve to do God's will (to be like God), but in the way of **SELF**.

    EXAMPLE Satan tempted Jesus to do what was His right to do, but on **SELF**'s schedule…instead of God's schedule.
  - The issue for every pastor, missionary, church leader and church member to consider is this: Under who's

CONTROL am I doing what I do? We should always be in a mode of SELF-examination.

KEY QUESTION Am I under God's control or self's control?

- We can lead people to Christ and even teach the word of God, all in the power of our flesh…and appear very spiritual.

- The truth is that living in the flesh is *pseudo spirituality*

Pseudo – Artificial; Bogus; Counterfeit; Fake; False; Phony; Quasi

Pseudo Spirituality describes the "bridges" Christians try to build from flesh to Spirit, attempting to live in both worlds at the same time.

- Ways our flesh can attempt to be spiritual:

  - LEGALISM

    Man-made **SYSTEMS** of preferences that force someone to obey a set of rules or standards in order to be spiritual...we all must be careful!

    Obedience is **EXTERNAL**, yet true biblical submission is ***internal***.

    Disciplined flesh does not necessarily represent true spirituality or victory. Instead, it can lead to SELF-righteousness – Luke 18:9-14.

    Legalism is man's attempt to live with the appearance of spirituality with an unchanged spirit towards God's commands… ending up no different than the Pharisees – Matt. 23:1-12; Mark 7.

    Legalism often breeds a "secret" double life...

    NOTE This occurs when someone acts one way at church or around certain people and acts like someone else with others or in private – James 1:8.

    Legalism is more than hair length and dress codes...

    NOTE *Qualities that often accompany legalism: A legalistic heart often questions the motives and character of **others**. A legalistic person is often looking for "**DIRT**" on others. A legalistic person often thinks others have "something to hide". Be careful when you begin to think everyone else is wrong…*

Week 5

- Ways our flesh can attempt to be spiritual continued…

  - GOOD WORKS

    If I do enough **GOOD** things, then I am spiritual.

    My flesh can do many "good" things.

    The main issue is BEING, not DOING – Lk.10:38-42; Mt. 22:36-37

    Good works can make us feel like we are victorious...

    TRUTH Biblical men/women who **WALK** with God God the credit for every good works – James genuinely give thing...including good 1:17.

  - The "good" works of the flesh:

    The flesh is capable of doing good things – Lk. 11:42 – Good works are right…using them to glorify our flesh instead of God is not!

    When the flesh learns it is no longer allowed to do evil, it will do good in order to maintain **CONTROL**. Once control is established, it will soon revert to evil again - 1 Sam. 15:10-23.

  KEY We cannot fight our flesh with our **FLESH** – Gal. 3:1-3; 2:16; 1 Cor. 1:26-31; 2 Cor. 10:1-5.

  - RECOGNIZING the "good" works of the flesh:

    Self-willed is not easily led (lack of humbleness)
    Self-disciplined is not easily adjusted (entrenchedness)
    Self-confidence is not easily criticized (closedness)
    Self-motivated is not easily led (stubbornness)

- The RESULTS of the "good" works of the flesh:

  Self leads the way and asks **GOD** to come along.
  - Your self-control results from a self-led life. This is a lot of work to maintain, and yet Jesus' burden is to be light - Matt. 11:28-30.
    Self- righteousness will ultimately result in **unrighteousness** (pride, judging, etc.) – Matt. 27:3-7.

KEY The whole goal of true spirituality is the absolute lack of confidence in self and the flesh. To come to the place where all of our confidence is in God, **His** power, **His** Spirit and **His WORD** to direct us.

- Satan's Role with our flesh:

The flesh is Satan's workshop. Though evicted at salvation, he left his estate behind – Eph. 2:1-3.

When overt sin is prohibited, he can fill our lives with so much GOOD looking works that there is no room for GOD. Remember: Satan's sin was not immorality or murder, it was self-will (pride).

KEY All unrighteousness in the world has at its root **PRIDE** – Is.14:12-14!

As long as we are doing God's stuff for self, the spiritual powers know the difference – Acts 19:13-17.

NOTE Satan seeks a throne to rule. Though he CANNOT possess a believer sealed by the Spirit of God, he CAN "rule" them through their flesh…**the enemy inside**.

- Religion's Role with our flesh:

Religion is man working his way to be justified with God. Genuine salvation is God justifying those who could **NEVER** justify themselves.

- It is very easy for us to live in religious systems we've created:

Church attendance, tithing, baptism, visitation,

*discipleship, mission trips, etc…all good things that **CAN** become religious.*

Consider what your spiritual life would be like in solitary confinement for 3 months…if all religious things were removed?

- The Role of Knowledge and our flesh:

  Knowledge in the ***head*** does not necessarily mean spirituality in the ***heart***.

  Contrary to popular belief, knowledge is **NOT** power...Knowledge is potential power – 1 Cor. 8:1: Eph. 3:14-19.

  One of the biggest battles faced by those who have been Christians for any length of time is their "familiarity" with the Word of God.

  It is easy to be fooled by the flesh into thinking we are spiritual because we "know" a verse/passage and we "understand" the "concept" of it, and we can automatically believe we are doing it. We think we believe it, but in reality, we may not...

- Spiritual Experiences and our flesh:

  - Listening to "Christian" music

    Listening/singing along with Christian music is very beneficial and can truly minister to us in our Christian walk (Eph. 5:18-20; Col. 3:16), but it also has the strange potential to make us feel spiritual and strong when we actually aren't.

  - Listening to audio sermons

  - Reading "Christian" books

    *Like audio sermons, they can be good…however they cannot replace the Bible as the **AUTHORITY** of our lives!*

  - Exciting, emotional "spiritual experiences"

*They make us "feel good"…but it does not necessarily make us closer to God! They make us "feel religious"…but it can be prostitute spirituality! Many people are into these "experiences" and come to prefer the **FEELING** over the Word of God – 2 Tim. 4:3-4!*

KEY Believing the Word of God and acting upon those beliefs are the only truly "spiritual" things we can do! - Luke 11:27-28

Week 6

4. Keys to empowering the Spirit of God as we seek to walk with God

a. Getting victory over my deceitful flesh

- God reveals a relatively **SIMPLE** Biblical process to us in Romans 6:

  - **First**, we must understand the doctrinal truth that we are not stuck to our sinful flesh anymore being forced to obey it. We are **FREE** through Christ's Spirit to obey – Ro. 6:6-7, 18-22; Col. 2:10-12.

- **Second**, we must ALWAYS reckon these things to be so. *Reckon* = recognize. I must see it the way it is and call it for what it is every day – Ro. 6:11; Gal. 2:20.

  A very handy phrase to use when reckoning the flesh as dead - "Dead men don't **CARE**!"

- **Third**, we must not **LET** sin reign in our mortal bodies - Ro. 6:12-13. *Reign = When a sovereign rules on a throne*.

  Our battles with our flesh can be a very taxing burden. It can become easy to just give up and turn over the controls to the flesh. It seems easier – Php. 4:13. We must fight and die **DAILY** to walk with God - 1 Cor. 15:31.

- **Finally**, we must guard OUR members…am I yielding them unto sin, or unto God as one WHO IS ALIVE from the dead? – Ro. 6:13,16

  Feet – Where do I ALLOW my feet to take me?
  Eyes – What do I ALLOW my eyes to view?
  Mouth – What do I ALLOW my mouth to say/consume?
  Ears – What do I ALLOW my ears to hear?
  Hands/Fingers – What do I ALLOW my hands/fingers to touch?

  NOTE ***"Let"*** *and* ***"yield"*** *are words of choice. We do not have to lose our battles or our war with our flesh. It is truly* ***OUR*** *choice* – 2 Tim. 4:6-7; Rom. 7:14-25.

  KEY *Why are OUR CHOICES so important?* – 1 Cor. 6:20.

- Other practical battlefield tips to empower God's Spirit and kill our flesh:

  NOTE *God sees* **NO** *hope for our flesh…Therefore, the*

only solution for the flesh until our body is redeemed is a daily death!

- Consider that if you are in Christ (*i.e.* saved) and continue to live after the flesh, you will **DIE** – Ro. 8:10-13

  An inside struggle and fight is a good, healthy thing!

- The Holy Spirit within us battles against our flesh – Gal. 4:29; 5:17

- Remember that the battlefield starts in the **MIND** – 2 Cor. 10:3-5

- Failure will result if we **only kill fleshly things** but do not empower spiritual things – Col. 3.

  NOTE Failure will ALSO result when we **only empower spiritual things**, but don't deal with the flesh.

- We must make no provisions for the flesh…**STARVE** it – Ro. 13:14

- RESULTS of empowering God's Holy Spirit:

  - The Holy Spirit always **MAGNIFIES** the Lord Jesus – John 16:12-15

  - Following the Spirit eliminates failure. God doesn't fail.

  - Following the Spirit produces **FRUIT** – John 15:16; Gal. 5:22-23

Homework: Read Romans 6-8 before next Wednesday.

These chapters are the basis for this study.

Week 7

b. Practical, Biblical activities that will empower the Spirit and strengthen our walk with God

- **READ** your Bible every day – Is. 34:16; 1 Tim. 4:13; Luke 4:16

  NOTE Reading is not studying. The Bible is a **consistent diet** of God's food for us… packed with "vitamins" which yields fruit in our life. Most times God's Word is working inside of us when we read it, just like food does in our bodies, in ways we do not understand for our good – Job 23:12; Jer. 15:16.

- **STUDY** your Bible – 2 Tim. 2:15

  NOTE Don't let others do all the studying for you! God wants to use you in your walk with Him to get others answers – 1 Pet 3:15.

- **PRAY** every day – Luke 18:1; Phil. 4:6; 1 Thess. 5:17

  NOTE Prayer is our personal connection and opportunity to talk with God! Pray expecting God to respond. Watch and listen for His direction – James 1:5-7; Eph. 6:18; Col. 4:2.

- Be with the church when they assemble – Acts 2:42-47; Heb.10:25; Jude 19

  - **CHANGE** your lifestyle to accommodate gathering with God's people

  - Prepare for Sunday on Saturday, **NOT** Sunday morning

  - Have a servant's heart when you come (Be submissive…) – Eph. 5:21.

  - Have a **TENDER** heart when you come (Be willing to change…)

NOTE We have no idea what God has in mind for us to give and get at any given meeting as we gather together in His name. But we must come prepared and expecting of God to do great things!

- **GIVE** cheerfully – 2 Cor. 9:7
  - Your time … does God get much of your time?
  - Your talents … do your talents get used by God for His glory?
  - Your treasures... start by tithing *(10%)* from your total earnings

    NOTE We can rob God by how we handle our finances! Mal 3:8

    REMEMBER *God loveth a cheerful giver.*

- Do the work of the Lord
  - Tell the lost about Christ – Rom. 1:16
  - Strengthen believers in the Lord (disciple) – Matt. 28:18-20; 2 Tim. 2:2

    NOTE God wants our lives to abound in the work of the Lord! – 1 Cor. 15:58

- Be forgiving and **HUMBLE** toward others – 1 Cor. 3:1-4; Eph. 4:31-32; 5:21

  NOTE If you cannot…you are not walking with God in the Spirit! You are living carnally (that old fleshly way)!

FINAL THOUGHT These are all important Biblical areas that accompany a healthy walk with God. How are you doing in each of these areas? Talk with God about them, and then walk with God in them.

Week 8

c. The necessity and consistency of God's Word in our walk with God

- The Bible is **ALIVE** – Heb. 4:12.

  - There is no other book on this planet like the Bible. It is supernatural…given from above. We read it, and it reads us. It is a perfect mirror – James 1:22-25.

  - We must be careful how we approach it (Him) – John 1:1-5, 14-15; 1 John 5:7; Mark 11:27-33.

  - The Bible is **GOD'S** book…it is not open to private interpretation – 2 Pet. 1:20-21.

- The Bible is compared to water – Is. 55:10-11; Eph. 5:25-26.

  - The maximum time a person can go without consuming water is a week under normal conditions. Every cell in our body uses water. Water sustains us **inside** and also keeps us clean on the outside.

- The Bible is compared to food. Jesus specifically compares it to bread…supernatural, **daily bread** (daily = every day) – Luke 4:4,11:3.

  - Manna was supernatural bread that God consistently gave the nation of Israel – Ex. 16:15-21.

    ***v. 15a* – Manna =** what is it**?**
    v. 15b – This Lord gave them this bread.
    v. 16a – **Every man** was to gather it.
    v. 16b – Share it with those you live with.
    v. 17-18 – Share it with others so no one lacks (**FELLOWSHIP**)
    v. 19-20 – Be careful not to gather it and just let it sit.
    v. 21a – Gather it every morning.
    v. 21b – If not gathered, the blessing provided for that day disappears.

    NOTE God faithfully delivered His supernatural bread to

His people every day for **40** years! – Ex. 16:35-36

- Planning a **place** to meet with God every day…for a "Quiet Time"
  - God is **consistently** there with His provision for each day. We must work to have **CONSISTENCY** on our end of the relationship.
  - Pick a quiet place – Ps. 46:10; 1 Thess. 4:11
  - Remove distractions – Mark 1:35
  - Pick a place in the Bible – 2 Tim. 3:16; Is. 55:11

- A Powerful Quiet Time…more than just reading the Bible

P **Pray** to begin your time with God – Ps. 119:18

O **Open** yourself before God…be **VULNERABLE** – Heb. 4:13

W Word of God – **Read**

E **Expect** to hear from God – James 1:5-7

R **Respond** to what God gives you…journal, memorize, **MEDITATE** – Josh. 1:8; Psalm 119:15, 97, 99; James 1:22-25

FINAL THOUGHT

Imagine walking with someone and never interacting with them. God designed our walk with Him through this world to be an interactive adventure. As Adam and Eve once did, we again can walk and talk with God in the cool of the day. He has given us a **living Spirit** and a **living Book** to enable us to do so.

Week 9

5. The next 3 weeks will detail the doctrines of Justification, Sanctification & Glorification as they concern our Walk with God.

a. Justification

- **DEFINING** justification

- Justification means to "prove as just"; to declare "not guilty" or to declare "righteous." Justification, in a court of law, is a settled legal matter pronouncing a proper **LEGAL** standing or position. It often involves acquittal, vindication, or acceptance before a judge.

- Deuteronomy 25:1 - The question is **NOT** one of moral improvement. Judges do not make the right person a better person. They simply render a decision vindicating a person's position as satisfactory or unsatisfactory according to the law.

- **WHO** is Biblically justified and who is the justifier?

- Rom. 3:23-27, 8:33 – A person is justified **FREELY** by God's grace through the redemption found in Christ alone. **GOD** declares that person "just" in His sight when he meets God's conditions.

NOTE A person cannot make himself just before God – Luke 16:15. Justification in the New Testament is solely based upon the grace of God through Christ's sacrifice.

- **HOW** and **WHEN** is a person justified? What exactly are God's conditions?

- Rom. 3:28 – *"Therefore we conclude that a man is justified **by faith** without the deeds of the law."* See also Gal. 2:16.

- To better understand how justification is obtained by faith

alone, God refers us the testimonies of Abraham and David – Rom. 4:1-8.

Gen 15:1-6 – Why was Abraham justified? He heard what God said and simply believed God by faith. This is the **first mention** of the word "believe" in the Bible.
Rom. 4:5 summarizes **how/when** a person is justified by faith.
David was a murderer/adulterer and should have received no grace from God. Yet God did not *impute* his sin (*put on his account*) upon him, but God did *impute* righteousness upon him – Acts 13:26-39.

- **WHAT** actually happens the moment God justifies a person?

  - Rom. 5:1 – Receiving God's satisfactory payment for sins causes God to declare us justified. At that moment we are justified in Heaven by faith in Christ alone and ARE at **PEACE** with God forever.

  - Justification is the ***legal act***, the ***Heavenly transaction,*** whereby a person's guilty status before God is forever changed based on Christ's merits. He becomes a Christian… or little "Christ."

    Because of Christ's *imputed* righteousness, a Christian becomes good and righteous, sinless in the eternal eyes of God – 1 John 3:9.

    A Christian is only seen, and will only be seen as ***NOT GUILTY*** before God because of genuine faith in Christ.

- Confusion between Romans vs. James?

  Romans 4:1-5 God declares in Romans that it was through faith that Abraham was justified before God.

  James 2:20-26 James declares that Abraham's works justified him.

  So which is it? First of all, these passages are referring to two different "faith" events in Abraham's life. **Romans** is referring to Gen. 15:1-6 and the stars incident, while **James** is referring to an incident 40 years later in Abraham's life concerning sacrificing his only son Isaac – Gen. 22.

Faith alone, without any accompanying proofs, is dead. There's no proof it exists! Justifying faith will not only be faith, but will have Godly **WORKS** that accompany (or justify) and prove it – see Eph. 2:8-**10**; Heb. 11.

SUMMARY Human judges justify the innocent – God only justifies the guilty!

Man justifies on the basis of self-merit – God justifies on the basis of Christ's merit.

I should walk with God understanding I am justified through faith in His son Jesus Christ…free from **GUILT** – 2 Cor. 7:8-11.

Rom 5:1-2 – *"Therefore being justified by faith, **we have peace with God** through our Lord Jesus Christ: By whom also **we have access by faith into this grace** wherein we stand, **and rejoice** in hope of the glory of God."*

Week 10

Reminder of the Goal of this Series…*Walking with God* - To teach the Bible Believer the basics of his past, present, and future relationship to Jesus Christ in order to have victory over sin and bring glory to God on a daily basis.

Reviewing Biblical Justification:

- Biblical Justification = A Christian's position and **LEGAL** standing before Holy God. A Christian is at peace with God and completely righteous in God's sight for eternity because of **FAITH** in the finished work of Jesus Christ **alone** – Rom. 5:1.

- Why is the doctrine of justification important as we seek to walk with God?

- John 5:24 – *"Verily, verily, I say unto you, He that **heareth** my word, and **believeth** on him that sent me, hath everlasting life, and shall not come into condemnation; but is passed from death unto life."*

b. Sanctification

- **DEFINING** sanctification

  - Sanctification means to "set apart" or to be "separated." See its first uses in the Bible – Gen. 2:3; Ex. 13:2.

  - Sanctification is the **FRUIT** of a justified life. Once a believer is justified by faith in Christ, sanctification (separation) occurs **immediately**, can occur **daily**, and will occur **forever**.

- **THE ORDER** of sanctification

  - **Separated POSITIONALLY** at the moment of salvation by the Holy Spirit - 1 Cor. 6:11; Heb. 10:8-10; 2 Thess. 2:13; Col. 2:11-12.

  - **Separated PRACTICALLY** on a **DAILY** basis by our choices
    Sanctification in our daily life is based on our interactions with God's **WORD** and God's Spirit – John 17:17; Eph. 5:26.
    Jesus is our model of a set apart life – John 17:19; Rom. 15:3.

When we allow ourselves to be set apart, we can be used by the Master in any way he chooses – 2 Tim. 2:19-21; 1 Thess. 4:3-8.
This sanctification causes separation – Acts 13:2; Php. 3:7-8.

c. Comparing Justification vs. Sanctification

- In justification, our standing is changed before God. Sanctification deals with the nature of our character before God.

- Justification is what God does **FOR** us. Sanctification is what God can do **IN** us.

- Justification is an act. Sanctification is a work.

- Justification is safe. Sanctification is sound.

- Justification removes the guilt of sin. Sanctification keeps in check the potential to sin.

- Justification is the means. Sanctification is the end.
  As believers, we have been justified and sanctified enabling us to grow, mature, and walk **WITH** God now and forever.

Next week: Our last stage of sanctification

- Future **Separation PHYSICALLY** in a new body – *1 Thess. 5:23*; *Rm 8:29-39*

  .

  NOTHING is going to stop the eternal sanctification of the believer!
  A Christian will be eternally separated from sin, death, and hell.

Week 11

Reviewing Biblical Justification:

- Biblical Justification = A Christian's position and legal standing before a Holy God. A Christian is at peace with God and completely righteous in God's sight for eternity because of **FAITH** in the finished work of Jesus Christ alone. Justification is instant at _____ salvation – Rm. 5:1.

Reviewing Biblical Sanctification:

- Biblical Sanctification = A Christian's practical **DAILY** separation from the world unto God and His Will. This separation comes through choices, interactions and responses to God's word and God's Spirit, allowing the Christian to be used by the Master in any way He chooses. Sanctification is an ongoing process – Eph. 5:26

d. Glorification

- Defining Glorification

- Glorification means exaltation to honor and dignity. It's elevation to glory. We see this with the glorification of Christ *after* His resurrection and ascension – Lk. 24:26-27; Jn. 7:39; 12:16, 23-24; Acts 3:13-15

  Glorification involves a DEATH and a RESURRECTION… ending with an ascension**.**

- Glorification to the believer is NOT an elevation for our glory, but rather for us to be **WITH** the Glorified Christ **IN** Glory – Ps. 73:24; 113:4; Rm. 8:29-30; I Tim. 3:16; Heb. 2:10; I Pet. 5:10

  Future: The last stage of sanctification when believers will be separated **PHYSICALLY** and ETERNALLY from earth in a new body – II Cor. 3:18 4:6-7; I Thess. 5:23;

Col. 1:27; 3:4.
Nothing is going to stop the eternal sanctification of the believer – Rm. 8:29-39.
A Christian will be eternally separated from sin, death, and hell –
II Thess. 2.

- This is also called adoption – Rm. 8:23; I Cor. 15:42-58; Eph. 4:30

There's a **SPIRITUAL** adoption at the moment of salvation – Gal. 4:5-6; Rm. 8:14-16.
There's a **PHYSICAL** adoption at the Rapture – Rm. 8:17-19; Eph. 1:5, 11-14.

6. *Knowing that God* has called man to justification by means of salvation, and has predestinated the believers unto sanctification and future glorification, it should provoke us to **RESPOND** zealously and in all humility!

- *Knowing that God*, willing to save man from the consequences of his own sin, yet loved us enough to send His Son to die for us…
- *Knowing that God* didn't just want to save us and then abandon us, but desires a relationship with his redeemed, and so sent his Spirit to live inside of the believer…
- *Knowing that God,* Who now lives within us and us in Him, is still quenched and grieved by our sin…
- *Knowing that God*, despite our sin, still allows us to remain in him and receive the inheritance of blessings, even being made joint heirs with His Son…
- *Knowing that God* has prepared a place for his church to help rule and reign with Him for all eternity…
- *Knowing* that God did all this for us and so much more…it should cause us to change our **BEHAVIOUR** and live according to his Will, and not our own!!

KEY: Remember **WHO** you're walking with, and what He's done for you!

Next Week

In our last week, we will look at God's growth model for every believer. Come see

where you are in God's process of growth and where **EVERY** believer should be headed!

Week 12

Keys to remember as we approach this last topic…

- When proper discipleship takes place, the disciple will grow through a seven stage process as he or she walks with God.
- This pattern was established by the Lord Jesus Christ with His twelve disciples and then with the seventy.
- These same seven stages can be observed in the development of the apostle Paul.
- It is important for us to understand these stages and identify where we are in our personal ***walk with Christ***.
- Close observation of any Christian will reveal their present stage of spiritual growth.
- This process is not only for pastors, missionaries or those who are called to vocational ministry. ***This process should unfold in the life of every believer.***

7. Spiritual Development and Reproduction (also known as the NT Process of Discipleship)

   a. The Seven Stages of a Disciple

#1 - Repentance – The starting point

- Repent means to turn and **CHANGE** beliefs, directions, etc. – Mt. 21:28-29.

- God desires all men to repent and be saved – Acts 17:30-31, 20:21; 2 Pet. 3:9.
- **GENUINE** repentance and faith results in a changed life – Acts 26:20; 2 Cor. 5:21.

#2 - Enlightenment – Getting to know God…*"learn of me;" "come and see"*

- God desires to enlighten us as to who he is – Matt. 11:25-29; John 1:1, 14, 37-50.
- Learning from mature believers is God's plan (discipleship) – Matt. 28:18-20; Acts 8:29-35; 2 Tim. 2:2.
- Some Biblical examples of discipleship: Moses/Joshua, Elijah/Elisha, Naomi/Ruth, Priscilla/Aquila and Apollos, Jesus and the Twelve, Luke/Theopholis (Luke/Acts), Paul/Titus, Paul/Timothy
- John 13:15 – *"For I have given you an example, that ye should do as I have done to you."*

#3 - Life Application – Applying what you know to life

- Knowledge brings **ACCOUNTABILITY**…a desire to pass on what has been learned.
- Luke 12:48…*For unto whomsoever much is given, of him shall be much required…*
- Practical life application of Biblical truth will be evidenced in a disciple's life:

    * Follows Christ in obedience *(baptism, giving, etc.)*
    * Follows Christ in **SUBMISSION** *(attitude)* Col. 3:22-23
    * Ambassador for Christ – 2 Cor. 5:18-20; 1 Cor. 3:9; Acts 9:15-23
    * Persecuted as Christ's servant – 2 Tim. 3:12; 1 Pet. 4:1-4
    * Successfully works through the trials/tests of life – James 1:2-5

#4 - **LEADERSHIP** Development – Becoming a powerful influence for Christ

- ***Followers*** become leaders. A ***good follower*** will make a ***good leader*** – Mark 9:35.
- **EVERY** follower, to some degree or another, is purposed to become a good leader...
- Jesus' focus was to develop leaders to lead others. True leaders follow His pattern.

KEY Genuine leaders have genuine followers whom they are training. False leaders have "blind" followers. Blind followers have trouble doing anything that has lasting value, just like their leaders – Matt 15:13-14.

- While everyone has a capacity to be a leader, church leadership is ordained by God and will be successful with obedience – 1 Cor. 12:12-27; Eph. 4:11-16; Acts 6:1-7.
- Godly leadership is the key to success - Prov. 29:2.
- Is there anyone following you?

#5 - Testing and Separation - A trial(s) that puts faith severely to the test

- God proves (**TESTS**) every disciple for the next level – 1 Pet.1:6-7, 4:12-13.
- A good teacher gives his students hard tests to prove them.
- This testing is ***not*** like the normal problems of everyday life.
- This testing is ***not*** connected to sin in the disciple's life.
- This testing involves a ***crisis*** that leads to a "point of no return."
- These tests lead to an "all our nothing" attitude.
- The results:
    * A completely transformed life that will **NEVER** be the same.
    * Separation from the world on a grander scale occurs.
- The proper foundation of strong biblical discipleship is key at this point because ***everyone*** who makes it to this stage will eventually come to this crossroad. This is to be expected, do not be surprised. Abraham was likely not surprised by God's testing – James 2:19-23; Heb. 11:17-19.
- This proving is often intense/severe – John 6:66-70; 1 Kings 2:1-6; Job 13:15.

#6 - **LEADERSHIP** after testing – a new look and outlook

- On the other side of this testing, the disciple looks differently.
- The disciple has clear evidence of ***fruit*** after **PURGING** – John 15:1-2.
- They are now a better leader. At this time the disciple is empowered for greater responsibility.
- This stage is important because the disciple must put into **PRACTICE** what has been learned. They now live out their decisions made during testing time.
- There are no textbooks that can make a person this kind of a leader. It must be learned by experience – Rom. 5:3-5.
- Leaders who have been through the fire themselves exemplify maturity in their character *(temperance, extra compassion for others, empathy, tolerance, etc.)* – Matt. 15:21-32; 20:30-34; 23:37; Luke 19:41-42.

#7 - World Vision – a consistently sanctified life

- All major principles of the Christian life have been learned, practiced, and tested – Php. 3:10.
- The disciple sees this world the way God sees it in every capacity – Gal. 6:14.

- The disciple knows what he/she is to do because they know God deeply.
- The disciple has a life that truly exemplifies being a stranger/pilgrim in this world – Heb. 11:13; 1 Pet. 2:11-12.

KEY The disciple is commissioned to reach the world and ***entirely expects*** to ***accomplish that mission***.

b. Summarizing this Process of Growth…

- Not everyone is called to vocational ministry *(pastor or missionary)*, but everyone is called to the ministry. **EVERYONE** can do something important for God. How this calling works out practically in the lives of people will differ. However, **EVERY** believer is designed to come through this process successfully. God gave us a Book with everything we need and placed His Holy Spirit inside us at the moment of salvation. There is no excuse.

KEY "**WALKING** with God" is not always the easiest journey, but it is the best journey with the best intentions of our great God always at work – Rom. 8:28! God promises to always walk with us through all things – Heb. 13:5!

WALKING WITH GOD



MBC – "Next Steps" Bible Study

The Goal of this Series

To teach the Bible Believer the basics of his past, present, and future relationship to Jesus Christ *in order to have victory over sin and bring glory to God on a daily basis*.

Some of the issues we will deal with in this series are as follows:

1. The nature and condition of mankind
2. The enemies of a Believer and the ensuing warfare that is encountered
3. Living a life of Victory
4. Justification and sanctification
5. Spiritual development and reproduction

Key Text: Galatians 5:25

Galatians 5:25 - *"If we **live** in the Spirit, let us also **walk** in the Spirit."*

Week 1

Introduction

1. The Spiritual Christian

Our salvation introduced us to an intense struggle for true, biblical spirituality. A battle now exists between our flesh and our spirit *(Galatians 5:17)*.

KEY This battle ***cannot be won*** by suppressing the desires of the flesh through our own willpower. (2 Corinthians 10:3-5; Romans 8:13)

Yet, God made us to have **VICTORY** over the flesh. Unfortunately, many believers seem to be losing that battle. As in any warfare there must be an equipping with the proper weapons, accompanied by ample training to use them.

We will seek to accomplish this "equipping and training" in order to achieve the overall goal of this series.

As we begin our study, let's consider some Biblical facts about our relationship with God:

a. We must allow God's truth to **TRANSFORM** us, not merely inform us – Philippians 4:9; James 1:21-25

NOTE *Informed* = Learned, Received, Heard, Seen

Transformed = **CHANGED** in form…*and the God of peace shall be with you.*

b. Spirituality is not determined by what we do for God, but rather, it is who we are **WITH** God – Genesis 3:8, 5:21-24; Hebrews 11:5; Rev. 2:2-5

NOTE A real, truly Biblical Christian is one who doesn't just do all the right things, but one who knows God! Superficiality breaks down eventually. One who is truly spiritual is changed from deep within and it then works its way out!

c. True Biblical spirituality is determined by our **DESIRE** to know God and to have an intimate relationship with Him – Mark 14:18-19; John 13:21-25; Luke 10:38-42; Philippians 3:8-10; James 4:8

NOTE Knowing God is what this is all about…

d. The desire to know Him was placed in our hearts at salvation and is made operative by the **HOLY SPIRIT** – Romans 8:15; Galatians 4:6

NOTE The Holy Spirit lives inside of us. You can't get more intimate than that! Yet, we don't often think of it in these terms.

e. It is possible to quench and **GRIEVE** the working of God's Spirit within us – 1 Thessalonians 5:19; Ephesians 4:25-30

f. Many have pointed out this progression, where we grieve the Spirit of God, this is the internal conviction when we sin. And, when we continue to do this, we quench (put out the fire/conviction/etc..) the Spirit of God.

g. When we stop feeling conviction, BEWARE! This is a dangerous spot for us to be in!

h. When we are quenching the Spirit, we are not "feeding" the Spirit, we are putting it out by our works of the flesh!

NOTE Because He is so close to us…because He is Holy…our sin and our apathy hurts Him!

f. Walking by faith and not by sight ... becoming a Biblically spiritual Christian is a **CHOICE** – Hebrews 11:23-26; Daniel 3:16-18

NOTE At some point in our Christian life, we must wake up to the realization that we make ***critical choices daily*** for God's glory or for our own.

Week 2

2. The Nature and Condition of Man

a. The Beginning – The Creation of Man **(OUR PAST)**

- Man was originally made in God's **IMAGE** *(before the fall)* – Genesis 1:27

God – Gen. 1:26; 1 John 5:7; John 1:1-2, 14; Gen. 1:1-3

1 - Father
2 - Son *(Word)*
3 - Holy Spirit

Man – Gen. 2:7; 1 Thess. 5:23; Heb. 4:12

1 - Soul – (Father)
2 - Body – (Son)
3 - Spirit – (Holy Spirit)

KEY *Man's* **SOUL** *is not necessarily visible to the naked eye but includes a person's character, uniqueness, and giftedness. It is comprised of such elements as the mind, the will, and the emotions (God gave man the ability to exercise his own free will as seen by the insertion of the "tree of the knowledge of good and evil" in Genesis).*

Man's **BODY** *is what the Bible calls* ***the flesh****.*

Man's **SPIRIT** *is what the Bible calls the* ***inner man****, a part of man designed by God to be strengthened/empowered by close, personal, "spiritual" fellowship with God through the Spirit of God (Eph. 3:16).*

b. The Problem – The Fall of Man

KEY This is very important and why we have problems.

- Man **DISOBEYED** God – Gen. 2:16-17; 3:1-6
- Man's **spiritual** part died immediately upon sinning – Gen. 3:8
- Man's **physical** body now ages and eventually **DIES** – Gen. 5:5
- As a result of his **spiritual** and **physical** condition, man's **soul** also suffers a slow decay – Gen. 3:17-19; Ps. 90:10

- Man's children are now born in his own image, not in the image of God – Gen. 5:1-3; Rom. 5:12, 14-19

Important Considerations:

*We **do not cease to exist** at death, but our soul separates from our bodies, from this world, and potentially from God forever (aka… "give up the ghost" – Gen. 25:8, 17; John 19:30; Acts 5:5). This same type of separation is seen as Adam immediately becomes estranged from God, unable to have* **FELLOWSHIP** *with Him until God reveals His redemptive plan.*

This is the spiritually dead condition of every man and woman at birth. This is where all of our troubles began.

We often refer to lost man as being a TWO *part being. This is only true in the sense that man's spirit is dead (unable to fellowship with God). Lost man is still a* THREE *part being with a body (#1), a soul (#2), and a* **DEAD** *spirit in relation to God (#3).*

c. Saved Man **(OUR PRESENT)**

- As the result of Jesus substitutionary death, burial, and bodily resurrection *(the gospel*), all who trust in Christ's finished work now have the image of God restored. When we believe the gospel we are "born again" and our once "dead" spirit is brought back to life *(fellowship is restored with God)*.

  - His Spirit makes **our spirit** alive, or quickened – Eph. 2:1; Rom. 8:16; 1 Co. 2:11; 6:16; Col 2:11-12

  - **Our soul** is now able to **CHOOSE** to meditate on life – Psalm 19:7; 23:3; 42:2...or death – Jud.16:16; 2 Pet. 2:8

  - **Our dying body** is still in this world – Rom. 7:23-24, but it is powerless over us – Ro. 6:6-9 and scheduled to be replaced – Php. 3:21

d. Glorified Man **(OUR FUTURE)**

- When we were born again, **our spirit** was made alive and joined to His Spirit, **our soul** was given the ability to be renewed by His Word and we were given the promise of **a new body**. When we see Him we shall be **LIKE** Him, for we shall see Him as He really

is in the fullness of all of His glory – 1 John 3:2; Rom. 8:29-31

- The Holy Spirit and His working in our lives was meant to be the **DOWN** payment, or earnest of our promised glorious inheritance – 2 Co. 1:22; 5:5; Eph. 1:13-14. This is the reason why we should so "earnestly" seek to be **filled with** and **walk after** His Spirit.

- Our born-again, Spirit-filled lives are God's manifestation to the **physical world**, and the **UNSEEN** **supernatural world** of God's eternal plan, wisdom, and glory – Col. 1:27; Eph 3:10-11, 21

KEY He designed us when reborn to display ***His glory*** in and through us to all…as fallen, yet **RESTORED** creations of God!

That is what our mission is…

That is our purpose as individuals…

That is our purpose as a group of believers (church)…

This information should change how we view everything about our lives!!!

Week 3

3. The Warfare of a Christian – The Flesh vs the Spirit

a. The nature of this warfare – Galatians 5:17; Romans 7:21-25; Matthew 26:41

- We face three enemies as born again Bible Believers

1 - The **WORLD** – John 17:10, 12-15; James 4:4

2 - The **FLESH** – Romans 7:24

3 - The **DEVIL** – 1 Peter 5:8; Luke 22:31-32

NOTE God's Spirit in union with our spirit is in a battle with these 3 enemies:

- All three enemies have already been defeated! (Good news!)

1 - The world is defeated by the **WORD** – 1 John 5:4-5; Romans 10:17

2 - The flesh is defeated by the **WORD** – Psalm 119:9-11; Romans 12:1-2

3 - The devil is defeated by the **WORD** – 1 John 2:12-14; Eph. 6:10-17

NOTE They are already defeated in that we have the competed Word of God!

- Winning or losing this warfare is our **CHOICE**!

NOTE Remember…faith is a choice. Heb 11:25

b. The nature of the flesh

- The flesh is defiled, corrupted, and rotten – 2 Peter 2:10-22; Rom 7:18

KEY The real problem is authority, who is in control: God or **SELF**? Remember the definition of the "Kingdom of God"…Jesus ***rules*** from the inside!

Consider what the Bible says about the flesh…

- It is **WEAK** toward God – Matthew 26:41

- It cannot please God – Romans 8:8

- It will **KILL** you – Romans 8:6,13

NOTE This is true both physically and spiritually (eternally).

- It cannot inherit God's kingdom – Romans 8:23; I Cor 15:50

- It seeks to persecute the Spirit – Galatians 4:29; 5:17

NOTE Ishmael was the ***natural*** son of a carnal choice. Isaac was the ***supernatural*** son of a work completed by God.

c. The works of the flesh

Text – Galatians 5:19-21

- Sins which defile the body:

  - Adultery – being **UNFAITHFUL** to your spouse or spiritual adultery.

    NOTE The strange woman...Proverbs 5…Rev 17:5…

  - Fornication – any sexual sin outside of the marriage covenant.

  - Uncleanness – any pollution or impurity of the flesh starting with a dirty, lustful mind.

    NOTE Generally, this applies to sexual sin, but it also refers to "dirty"…

  - Lasciviousness – lewd and **LOOSE** behavior, uncontrolled sensual (alluring; carnal; erotic; lustful; provocative;

sexual) desire.

- Communion with Satanic forces:
  - Idolatry – anything **BETWEEN** me and God.
  - Witchcraft – use of satanic power, occult activity (and rebellion) - I Sam 15:23. Also associated with drug use (witchcraft = ***pharmakeia*** in Greek)

- Pride (ungodly love of self) – the root of ***all*** sin:
  - Hatred – internal hostile feelings.
  - Variance – quarreling, **CONTENTION**.
  - Emulations – jealousy and envy of others. Trying to be superior.
  - Wrath – **ACTING** on anger/hatred…can be in the form of violence.
  - Strife – surrounded in controversy; causing division and factions

- Religion and its fruits:
  - Sedition – uprising against God-ordained authorities
  - Heresies – denying essential **BIBLE** truth/doctrine
  - Envyings – not satisfied, wanting what others have in the way of position, power, or persons.
  - Murders – to **KILL** another through literal or verbal means – James 4:1-3

  NOTE Verbal includes breaking someone's spirit creating deep, life-long, emotional scars…

- General vices:
  - Drunkenness – anything that **CONTROLS** your life.
  - Revellings – wild partying; disorderly, outlandish behavior
  - Such like – not just the law, but the spirit of the principles

of God

KEY The issue is not what is wrong with it, but rather what is right about it!

Week 4

- <u>The works of the flesh in a Christian's life…</u>

- All of the items from God's "flesh list" are a potential threat inside of us.

NOTE It is not the **DEVIL**, it is my flesh. We do have a very real enemy…but we can't blame the devil for our fleshly desires!

- The works of the flesh are activated OR deactivated by our yielding:

To the *<u>flesh</u>* …OR

To *<u>the Spirit</u>*.

KEY This is the key to walking with God!!!! – Ro. 6:13, 19; Gal. 5:16

- We must not **LET** the works of the flesh reign – Ro. 6:12

NOTE Are you a slave to our own lusts? If so, you are a freed slave.

Your Master has purchased you…you are free now…to serve Him and to bring glory to Him **right now** – John 8:36; Gal. 4:9!

- Romans 8:8 - *"So then they that are in the flesh **CANNOT** please God."* The biblical reality is that nothing accomplished in my Christian life, done in my flesh alone, is pleasing to God.

- Winning or losing this warfare is my **CHOICE**...

NOTE God allows us a free will, even after salvation, to

choose right from wrong.

Josh. 1:5-9; 24:15

a. Sin and self – Understanding the enemy that resides **INSIDE** of us!

- The Christian's relationship to sin:
  - My sin was dealt with on the cross – Ro. 6:6-7; Gal. 2:20; Col. 2:13-14.
  - I am **DEAD** to sin – Ro. 6:2

    NOTE It ceased to have power over my eternity the moment I was saved!
  - Sin **CANNOT** control me – Ro. 6:14
  - I sin because I **CHOOSE** to sin – James 1:14

    KEY *If uncontested, sin can **again** become a way of life* (*like we did when we were lost!)*

    We ***must*** do what Daniel did…Dan. 1:8.
- The Christian's relationship to self:
  - It is possible to do biblical things in the power of the flesh – Php. 1:16-18

    EXAMPLE Satan tempted Eve to do God's will (to be like God), but in the way of **SELF**.

    EXAMPLE Satan tempted Jesus to do what was His right to do, but on **SELF**'s schedule…instead of God's schedule.
  - The issue for every pastor, missionary, church leader and church member to consider is this: Under who's

CONTROL am I doing what I do? We should always be in a mode of SELF-examination.

KEY QUESTION Am I under God's control or self's control?

- We can lead people to Christ and even teach the word of God, all in the power of our flesh…and appear very spiritual.

- The truth is that living in the flesh is *pseudo spirituality*

Pseudo – Artificial; Bogus; Counterfeit; Fake; False; Phony; Quasi

Pseudo Spirituality describes the "bridges" Christians try to build from flesh to Spirit, attempting to live in both worlds at the same time.

- Ways our flesh can attempt to be spiritual:

  - LEGALISM

    Man-made **SYSTEMS** of preferences that force someone to obey a set of rules or standards in order to be spiritual...we all must be careful!

    Obedience is **EXTERNAL**, yet true biblical submission is ***internal***.

    Disciplined flesh does not necessarily represent true spirituality or victory. Instead, it can lead to SELF-righteousness – Luke 18:9-14.

    Legalism is man's attempt to live with the appearance of spirituality with an unchanged spirit towards God's commands… ending up no different than the Pharisees – Matt. 23:1-12; Mark 7.

    Legalism often breeds a "secret" double life...

    NOTE This occurs when someone acts one way at church or around certain people and acts like someone else with others or in private – James 1:8.

    Legalism is more than hair length and dress codes...

    NOTE *Qualities that often accompany legalism: A legalistic heart often questions the motives and character of **others**. A legalistic person is often looking for "**DIRT**" on others. A legalistic person often thinks others have "something to hide". Be careful when you begin to think everyone else is wrong…*

Week 5

- Ways our flesh can attempt to be spiritual continued…

  - GOOD WORKS

    If I do enough **GOOD** things, then I am spiritual.

    My flesh can do many "good" things.

    The main issue is BEING, not DOING – Lk.10:38-42; Mt. 22:36-37

    Good works can make us feel like we are victorious...

    TRUTH Biblical men/women who **WALK** with God God the credit for every good works – James genuinely give thing...including good 1:17.

  - The "good" works of the flesh:

    The flesh is capable of doing good things – Lk. 11:42 – Good works are right…using them to glorify our flesh instead of God is not!

    When the flesh learns it is no longer allowed to do evil, it will do good in order to maintain **CONTROL**. Once control is established, it will soon revert to evil again - 1 Sam. 15:10-23.

  KEY We cannot fight our flesh with our **FLESH** – Gal. 3:1-3; 2:16; 1 Cor. 1:26-31; 2 Cor. 10:1-5.

  - RECOGNIZING the "good" works of the flesh:

    Self-willed is not easily led (lack of humbleness)
    Self-disciplined is not easily adjusted (entrenchedness)
    Self-confidence is not easily criticized (closedness)
    Self-motivated is not easily led (stubbornness)

- The RESULTS of the "good" works of the flesh:

  Self leads the way and asks **GOD** to come along.
  - Your self-control results from a self-led life. This is a lot of work to maintain, and yet Jesus' burden is to be light - Matt. 11:28-30.
    Self- righteousness will ultimately result in **unrighteousness** (pride, judging, etc.) – Matt. 27:3-7.

KEY The whole goal of true spirituality is the absolute lack of confidence in self and the flesh. To come to the place where all of our confidence is in God, **His** power, **His** Spirit and **His WORD** to direct us.

- Satan's Role with our flesh:

The flesh is Satan's workshop. Though evicted at salvation, he left his estate behind – Eph. 2:1-3.

When overt sin is prohibited, he can fill our lives with so much GOOD looking works that there is no room for GOD. Remember: Satan's sin was not immorality or murder, it was self-will (pride).

KEY All unrighteousness in the world has at its root **PRIDE** – Is.14:12-14!

As long as we are doing God's stuff for self, the spiritual powers know the difference – Acts 19:13-17.

NOTE Satan seeks a throne to rule. Though he CANNOT possess a believer sealed by the Spirit of God, he CAN "rule" them through their flesh…**the enemy inside**.

- Religion's Role with our flesh:

Religion is man working his way to be justified with God. Genuine salvation is God justifying those who could **NEVER** justify themselves.

- It is very easy for us to live in religious systems we've created:

Church attendance, tithing, baptism, visitation,

*discipleship, mission trips, etc…all good things that **CAN** become religious.*

Consider what your spiritual life would be like in solitary confinement for 3 months…if all religious things were removed?

- The Role of Knowledge and our flesh:

  Knowledge in the ***head*** does not necessarily mean spirituality in the ***heart***.

  Contrary to popular belief, knowledge is **NOT** power...Knowledge is potential power – 1 Cor. 8:1: Eph. 3:14-19.

  One of the biggest battles faced by those who have been Christians for any length of time is their "familiarity" with the Word of God.

  It is easy to be fooled by the flesh into thinking we are spiritual because we "know" a verse/passage and we "understand" the "concept" of it, and we can automatically believe we are doing it. We think we believe it, but in reality, we may not...

- Spiritual Experiences and our flesh:

  - Listening to "Christian" music

    Listening/singing along with Christian music is very beneficial and can truly minister to us in our Christian walk (Eph. 5:18-20; Col. 3:16), but it also has the strange potential to make us feel spiritual and strong when we actually aren't.

  - Listening to audio sermons

  - Reading "Christian" books

    *Like audio sermons, they can be good…however they cannot replace the Bible as the **AUTHORITY** of our lives!*

  - Exciting, emotional "spiritual experiences"

*They make us "feel good"…but it does not necessarily make us closer to God! They make us "feel religious"…but it can be prostitute spirituality! Many people are into these "experiences" and come to prefer the **FEELING** over the Word of God – 2 Tim. 4:3-4!*

KEY Believing the Word of God and acting upon those beliefs are the only truly "spiritual" things we can do! - Luke 11:27-28

Week 6

4. Keys to empowering the Spirit of God as we seek to walk with God

a. Getting victory over my deceitful flesh

- God reveals a relatively **SIMPLE** Biblical process to us in Romans 6:

  - **First**, we must understand the doctrinal truth that we are not stuck to our sinful flesh anymore being forced to obey it. We are **FREE** through Christ's Spirit to obey – Ro. 6:6-7, 18-22; Col. 2:10-12.

- **Second**, we must ALWAYS reckon these things to be so. *Reckon* = recognize. I must see it the way it is and call it for what it is every day – Ro. 6:11; Gal. 2:20.

  A very handy phrase to use when reckoning the flesh as dead - "Dead men don't **CARE**!"

- **Third**, we must not **LET** sin reign in our mortal bodies - Ro. 6:12-13. *Reign = When a sovereign rules on a throne*.

  Our battles with our flesh can be a very taxing burden. It can become easy to just give up and turn over the controls to the flesh. It seems easier – Php. 4:13. We must fight and die **DAILY** to walk with God - 1 Cor. 15:31.

- **Finally**, we must guard OUR members…am I yielding them unto sin, or unto God as one WHO IS ALIVE from the dead? – Ro. 6:13,16

  Feet – Where do I ALLOW my feet to take me?
  Eyes – What do I ALLOW my eyes to view?
  Mouth – What do I ALLOW my mouth to say/consume?
  Ears – What do I ALLOW my ears to hear?
  Hands/Fingers – What do I ALLOW my hands/fingers to touch?

  NOTE ***"Let"*** *and* ***"yield"*** *are words of choice. We do not have to lose our battles or our war with our flesh. It is truly* ***OUR*** *choice* – 2 Tim. 4:6-7; Rom. 7:14-25.

  KEY *Why are OUR CHOICES so important?* – 1 Cor. 6:20.

- Other practical battlefield tips to empower God's Spirit and kill our flesh:

  NOTE *God sees* **NO** *hope for our flesh…Therefore, the*

only solution for the flesh until our body is redeemed is a daily death!

- Consider that if you are in Christ (*i.e.* saved) and continue to live after the flesh, you will **DIE** – Ro. 8:10-13

  An inside struggle and fight is a good, healthy thing!

- The Holy Spirit within us battles against our flesh – Gal. 4:29; 5:17

- Remember that the battlefield starts in the **MIND** – 2 Cor. 10:3-5

- Failure will result if we **only kill fleshly things** but do not empower spiritual things – Col. 3.

  NOTE Failure will ALSO result when we **only empower spiritual things**, but don't deal with the flesh.

- We must make no provisions for the flesh…**STARVE** it – Ro. 13:14

- RESULTS of empowering God's Holy Spirit:

  - The Holy Spirit always **MAGNIFIES** the Lord Jesus – John 16:12-15

  - Following the Spirit eliminates failure. God doesn't fail.

  - Following the Spirit produces **FRUIT** – John 15:16; Gal. 5:22-23

Homework: Read Romans 6-8 before next Wednesday.

These chapters are the basis for this study.

Week 7

b. Practical, Biblical activities that will empower the Spirit and strengthen our walk with God

- **READ** your Bible every day – Is. 34:16; 1 Tim. 4:13; Luke 4:16

  NOTE Reading is not studying. The Bible is a **consistent diet** of God's food for us… packed with "vitamins" which yields fruit in our life. Most times God's Word is working inside of us when we read it, just like food does in our bodies, in ways we do not understand for our good – Job 23:12; Jer. 15:16.

- **STUDY** your Bible – 2 Tim. 2:15

  NOTE Don't let others do all the studying for you! God wants to use you in your walk with Him to get others answers – 1 Pet 3:15.

- **PRAY** every day – Luke 18:1; Phil. 4:6; 1 Thess. 5:17

  NOTE Prayer is our personal connection and opportunity to talk with God! Pray expecting God to respond. Watch and listen for His direction – James 1:5-7; Eph. 6:18; Col. 4:2.

- Be with the church when they assemble – Acts 2:42-47; Heb.10:25; Jude 19

  - **CHANGE** your lifestyle to accommodate gathering with God's people

  - Prepare for Sunday on Saturday, **NOT** Sunday morning

  - Have a servant's heart when you come (Be submissive…) – Eph. 5:21.

  - Have a **TENDER** heart when you come (Be willing to change…)

NOTE We have no idea what God has in mind for us to give and get at any given meeting as we gather together in His name. But we must come prepared and expecting of God to do great things!

- **GIVE** cheerfully – 2 Cor. 9:7
  - Your time … does God get much of your time?
  - Your talents … do your talents get used by God for His glory?
  - Your treasures... start by tithing *(10%)* from your total earnings

    NOTE We can rob God by how we handle our finances! Mal 3:8

    REMEMBER *God loveth a cheerful giver.*

- Do the work of the Lord
  - Tell the lost about Christ – Rom. 1:16
  - Strengthen believers in the Lord (disciple) – Matt. 28:18-20; 2 Tim. 2:2

    NOTE God wants our lives to abound in the work of the Lord! – 1 Cor. 15:58

- Be forgiving and **HUMBLE** toward others – 1 Cor. 3:1-4; Eph. 4:31-32; 5:21

  NOTE If you cannot…you are not walking with God in the Spirit! You are living carnally (that old fleshly way)!

FINAL THOUGHT These are all important Biblical areas that accompany a healthy walk with God. How are you doing in each of these areas? Talk with God about them, and then walk with God in them.

Week 8

c. The necessity and consistency of God's Word in our walk with God

- The Bible is **ALIVE** – Heb. 4:12.

  - There is no other book on this planet like the Bible. It is supernatural…given from above. We read it, and it reads us. It is a perfect mirror – James 1:22-25.

  - We must be careful how we approach it (Him) – John 1:1-5, 14-15; 1 John 5:7; Mark 11:27-33.

  - The Bible is **GOD'S** book…it is not open to private interpretation – 2 Pet. 1:20-21.

- The Bible is compared to water – Is. 55:10-11; Eph. 5:25-26.

  - The maximum time a person can go without consuming water is a week under normal conditions. Every cell in our body uses water. Water sustains us **inside** and also keeps us clean on the outside.

- The Bible is compared to food. Jesus specifically compares it to bread…supernatural, **daily bread** (daily = every day) – Luke 4:4,11:3.

  - Manna was supernatural bread that God consistently gave the nation of Israel – Ex. 16:15-21.

    ***v. 15a* – Manna =** what is it**?**
    v. 15b – This Lord gave them this bread.
    v. 16a – **Every man** was to gather it.
    v. 16b – Share it with those you live with.
    v. 17-18 – Share it with others so no one lacks (**FELLOWSHIP**)
    v. 19-20 – Be careful not to gather it and just let it sit.
    v. 21a – Gather it every morning.
    v. 21b – If not gathered, the blessing provided for that day disappears.

    NOTE God faithfully delivered His supernatural bread to

His people every day for **40** years! – Ex. 16:35-36

- Planning a **place** to meet with God every day…for a "Quiet Time"
  - God is **consistently** there with His provision for each day. We must work to have **CONSISTENCY** on our end of the relationship.
  - Pick a quiet place – Ps. 46:10; 1 Thess. 4:11
  - Remove distractions – Mark 1:35
  - Pick a place in the Bible – 2 Tim. 3:16; Is. 55:11

- A Powerful Quiet Time…more than just reading the Bible

P **Pray** to begin your time with God – Ps. 119:18

O **Open** yourself before God…be **VULNERABLE** – Heb. 4:13

W Word of God – **Read**

E **Expect** to hear from God – James 1:5-7

R **Respond** to what God gives you…journal, memorize, **MEDITATE** – Josh. 1:8; Psalm 119:15, 97, 99; James 1:22-25

FINAL THOUGHT

Imagine walking with someone and never interacting with them. God designed our walk with Him through this world to be an interactive adventure. As Adam and Eve once did, we again can walk and talk with God in the cool of the day. He has given us a **living Spirit** and a **living Book** to enable us to do so.

Week 9

5. The next 3 weeks will detail the doctrines of Justification, Sanctification & Glorification as they concern our Walk with God.

a. Justification

- **DEFINING** justification

- Justification means to "prove as just"; to declare "not guilty" or to declare "righteous." Justification, in a court of law, is a settled legal matter pronouncing a proper **LEGAL** standing or position. It often involves acquittal, vindication, or acceptance before a judge.

- Deuteronomy 25:1 - The question is **NOT** one of moral improvement. Judges do not make the right person a better person. They simply render a decision vindicating a person's position as satisfactory or unsatisfactory according to the law.

- **WHO** is Biblically justified and who is the justifier?

- Rom. 3:23-27, 8:33 – A person is justified **FREELY** by God's grace through the redemption found in Christ alone. **GOD** declares that person "just" in His sight when he meets God's conditions.

NOTE A person cannot make himself just before God – Luke 16:15. Justification in the New Testament is solely based upon the grace of God through Christ's sacrifice.

- **HOW** and **WHEN** is a person justified? What exactly are God's conditions?

- Rom. 3:28 – *"Therefore we conclude that a man is justified **by faith** without the deeds of the law."* See also Gal. 2:16.

- To better understand how justification is obtained by faith

alone, God refers us the testimonies of Abraham and David – Rom. 4:1-8.

Gen 15:1-6 – Why was Abraham justified? He heard what God said and simply believed God by faith. This is the **first mention** of the word "believe" in the Bible.
Rom. 4:5 summarizes **how/when** a person is justified by faith.
David was a murderer/adulterer and should have received no grace from God. Yet God did not *impute* his sin (*put on his account*) upon him, but God did *impute* righteousness upon him – Acts 13:26-39.

- **WHAT** actually happens the moment God justifies a person?

  - Rom. 5:1 – Receiving God's satisfactory payment for sins causes God to declare us justified. At that moment we are justified in Heaven by faith in Christ alone and ARE at **PEACE** with God forever.

  - Justification is the ***legal act***, the ***Heavenly transaction,*** whereby a person's guilty status before God is forever changed based on Christ's merits. He becomes a Christian… or little "Christ."

    Because of Christ's *imputed* righteousness, a Christian becomes good and righteous, sinless in the eternal eyes of God – 1 John 3:9.

    A Christian is only seen, and will only be seen as ***NOT GUILTY*** before God because of genuine faith in Christ.

- Confusion between Romans vs. James?

  Romans 4:1-5 God declares in Romans that it was through faith that Abraham was justified before God.

  James 2:20-26 James declares that Abraham's works justified him.

  So which is it? First of all, these passages are referring to two different "faith" events in Abraham's life. **Romans** is referring to Gen. 15:1-6 and the stars incident, while **James** is referring to an incident 40 years later in Abraham's life concerning sacrificing his only son Isaac – Gen. 22.

Faith alone, without any accompanying proofs, is dead. There's no proof it exists! Justifying faith will not only be faith, but will have Godly **WORKS** that accompany (or justify) and prove it – see Eph. 2:8-**10**; Heb. 11.

SUMMARY Human judges justify the innocent – God only justifies the guilty!

Man justifies on the basis of self-merit – God justifies on the basis of Christ's merit.

I should walk with God understanding I am justified through faith in His son Jesus Christ…free from **GUILT** – 2 Cor. 7:8-11.

Rom 5:1-2 – *"Therefore being justified by faith, **we have peace with God** through our Lord Jesus Christ: By whom also **we have access by faith into this grace** wherein we stand, **and rejoice** in hope of the glory of God."*

Week 10

Reminder of the Goal of this Series…*Walking with God* - To teach the Bible Believer the basics of his past, present, and future relationship to Jesus Christ in order to have victory over sin and bring glory to God on a daily basis.

Reviewing Biblical Justification:

- Biblical Justification = A Christian's position and **LEGAL** standing before Holy God. A Christian is at peace with God and completely righteous in God's sight for eternity because of **FAITH** in the finished work of Jesus Christ **alone** – Rom. 5:1.

- Why is the doctrine of justification important as we seek to walk with God?

- John 5:24 – *"Verily, verily, I say unto you, He that **heareth** my word, and **believeth** on him that sent me, hath everlasting life, and shall not come into condemnation; but is passed from death unto life."*

b. Sanctification

- **DEFINING** sanctification

  - Sanctification means to "set apart" or to be "separated." See its first uses in the Bible – Gen. 2:3; Ex. 13:2.

  - Sanctification is the **FRUIT** of a justified life. Once a believer is justified by faith in Christ, sanctification (separation) occurs **immediately**, can occur **daily**, and will occur **forever**.

- **THE ORDER** of sanctification

  - **Separated POSITIONALLY** at the moment of salvation by the Holy Spirit - 1 Cor. 6:11; Heb. 10:8-10; 2 Thess. 2:13; Col. 2:11-12.

  - **Separated PRACTICALLY** on a **DAILY** basis by our choices
    Sanctification in our daily life is based on our interactions with God's **WORD** and God's Spirit – John 17:17; Eph. 5:26.
    Jesus is our model of a set apart life – John 17:19; Rom. 15:3.

When we allow ourselves to be set apart, we can be used by the Master in any way he chooses – 2 Tim. 2:19-21; 1 Thess. 4:3-8.
This sanctification causes separation – Acts 13:2; Php. 3:7-8.

c. Comparing Justification vs. Sanctification

- In justification, our standing is changed before God. Sanctification deals with the nature of our character before God.

- Justification is what God does **FOR** us. Sanctification is what God can do **IN** us.

- Justification is an act. Sanctification is a work.

- Justification is safe. Sanctification is sound.

- Justification removes the guilt of sin. Sanctification keeps in check the potential to sin.

- Justification is the means. Sanctification is the end.
  As believers, we have been justified and sanctified enabling us to grow, mature, and walk **WITH** God now and forever.

Next week: Our last stage of sanctification

- Future **Separation PHYSICALLY** in a new body – *1 Thess. 5:23*; *Rm 8:29-39*

  .

  NOTHING is going to stop the eternal sanctification of the believer!
  A Christian will be eternally separated from sin, death, and hell.

Week 11

Reviewing Biblical Justification:

- Biblical Justification = A Christian's position and legal standing before a Holy God. A Christian is at peace with God and completely righteous in God's sight for eternity because of **FAITH** in the finished work of Jesus Christ alone. Justification is instant at _____ salvation – Rm. 5:1.

Reviewing Biblical Sanctification:

- Biblical Sanctification = A Christian's practical **DAILY** separation from the world unto God and His Will. This separation comes through choices, interactions and responses to God's word and God's Spirit, allowing the Christian to be used by the Master in any way He chooses. Sanctification is an ongoing process – Eph. 5:26

d. Glorification

- Defining Glorification

- Glorification means exaltation to honor and dignity. It's elevation to glory. We see this with the glorification of Christ *after* His resurrection and ascension – Lk. 24:26-27; Jn. 7:39; 12:16, 23-24; Acts 3:13-15

  Glorification involves a DEATH and a RESURRECTION… ending with an ascension**.**

- Glorification to the believer is NOT an elevation for our glory, but rather for us to be **WITH** the Glorified Christ **IN** Glory – Ps. 73:24; 113:4; Rm. 8:29-30; I Tim. 3:16; Heb. 2:10; I Pet. 5:10

  Future: The last stage of sanctification when believers will be separated **PHYSICALLY** and ETERNALLY from earth in a new body – II Cor. 3:18 4:6-7; I Thess. 5:23;

Col. 1:27; 3:4.
Nothing is going to stop the eternal sanctification of the believer – Rm. 8:29-39.
A Christian will be eternally separated from sin, death, and hell –
II Thess. 2.

- This is also called adoption – Rm. 8:23; I Cor. 15:42-58; Eph. 4:30

There's a **SPIRITUAL** adoption at the moment of salvation – Gal. 4:5-6; Rm. 8:14-16.
There's a **PHYSICAL** adoption at the Rapture – Rm. 8:17-19; Eph. 1:5, 11-14.

6. *Knowing that God* has called man to justification by means of salvation, and has predestinated the believers unto sanctification and future glorification, it should provoke us to **RESPOND** zealously and in all humility!

- *Knowing that God*, willing to save man from the consequences of his own sin, yet loved us enough to send His Son to die for us…
- *Knowing that God* didn't just want to save us and then abandon us, but desires a relationship with his redeemed, and so sent his Spirit to live inside of the believer…
- *Knowing that God,* Who now lives within us and us in Him, is still quenched and grieved by our sin…
- *Knowing that God*, despite our sin, still allows us to remain in him and receive the inheritance of blessings, even being made joint heirs with His Son…
- *Knowing that God* has prepared a place for his church to help rule and reign with Him for all eternity…
- *Knowing* that God did all this for us and so much more…it should cause us to change our **BEHAVIOUR** and live according to his Will, and not our own!!

KEY: Remember **WHO** you're walking with, and what He's done for you!

Next Week

In our last week, we will look at God's growth model for every believer. Come see

where you are in God's process of growth and where **EVERY** believer should be headed!

Week 12

Keys to remember as we approach this last topic…

- When proper discipleship takes place, the disciple will grow through a seven stage process as he or she walks with God.
- This pattern was established by the Lord Jesus Christ with His twelve disciples and then with the seventy.
- These same seven stages can be observed in the development of the apostle Paul.
- It is important for us to understand these stages and identify where we are in our personal ***walk with Christ***.
- Close observation of any Christian will reveal their present stage of spiritual growth.
- This process is not only for pastors, missionaries or those who are called to vocational ministry. ***This process should unfold in the life of every believer.***

7. Spiritual Development and Reproduction (also known as the NT Process of Discipleship)

   a. The Seven Stages of a Disciple

#1 - Repentance – The starting point

- Repent means to turn and **CHANGE** beliefs, directions, etc. – Mt. 21:28-29.

- God desires all men to repent and be saved – Acts 17:30-31, 20:21; 2 Pet. 3:9.
- **GENUINE** repentance and faith results in a changed life – Acts 26:20; 2 Cor. 5:21.

#2 - Enlightenment – Getting to know God…*"learn of me;" "come and see"*

- God desires to enlighten us as to who he is – Matt. 11:25-29; John 1:1, 14, 37-50.
- Learning from mature believers is God's plan (discipleship) – Matt. 28:18-20; Acts 8:29-35; 2 Tim. 2:2.
- Some Biblical examples of discipleship: Moses/Joshua, Elijah/Elisha, Naomi/Ruth, Priscilla/Aquila and Apollos, Jesus and the Twelve, Luke/Theopholis (Luke/Acts), Paul/Titus, Paul/Timothy
- John 13:15 – *"For I have given you an example, that ye should do as I have done to you."*

#3 - Life Application – Applying what you know to life

- Knowledge brings **ACCOUNTABILITY**…a desire to pass on what has been learned.
- Luke 12:48…*For unto whomsoever much is given, of him shall be much required…*
- Practical life application of Biblical truth will be evidenced in a disciple's life:

    * Follows Christ in obedience *(baptism, giving, etc.)*
    * Follows Christ in **SUBMISSION** *(attitude)* Col. 3:22-23
    * Ambassador for Christ – 2 Cor. 5:18-20; 1 Cor. 3:9; Acts 9:15-23
    * Persecuted as Christ's servant – 2 Tim. 3:12; 1 Pet. 4:1-4
    * Successfully works through the trials/tests of life – James 1:2-5

#4 - **LEADERSHIP** Development – Becoming a powerful influence for Christ

- ***Followers*** become leaders. A ***good follower*** will make a ***good leader*** – Mark 9:35.
- **EVERY** follower, to some degree or another, is purposed to become a good leader...
- Jesus' focus was to develop leaders to lead others. True leaders follow His pattern.

KEY Genuine leaders have genuine followers whom they are training. False leaders have "blind" followers. Blind followers have trouble doing anything that has lasting value, just like their leaders – Matt 15:13-14.

- While everyone has a capacity to be a leader, church leadership is ordained by God and will be successful with obedience – 1 Cor. 12:12-27; Eph. 4:11-16; Acts 6:1-7.
- Godly leadership is the key to success - Prov. 29:2.
- Is there anyone following you?

#5 - Testing and Separation - A trial(s) that puts faith severely to the test

- God proves (**TESTS**) every disciple for the next level – 1 Pet.1:6-7, 4:12-13.
- A good teacher gives his students hard tests to prove them.
- This testing is ***not*** like the normal problems of everyday life.
- This testing is ***not*** connected to sin in the disciple's life.
- This testing involves a ***crisis*** that leads to a "point of no return."
- These tests lead to an "all our nothing" attitude.
- The results:
    * A completely transformed life that will **NEVER** be the same.
    * Separation from the world on a grander scale occurs.
- The proper foundation of strong biblical discipleship is key at this point because ***everyone*** who makes it to this stage will eventually come to this crossroad. This is to be expected, do not be surprised. Abraham was likely not surprised by God's testing – James 2:19-23; Heb. 11:17-19.
- This proving is often intense/severe – John 6:66-70; 1 Kings 2:1-6; Job 13:15.

#6 - **LEADERSHIP** after testing – a new look and outlook

- On the other side of this testing, the disciple looks differently.
- The disciple has clear evidence of ***fruit*** after **PURGING** – John 15:1-2.
- They are now a better leader. At this time the disciple is empowered for greater responsibility.
- This stage is important because the disciple must put into **PRACTICE** what has been learned. They now live out their decisions made during testing time.
- There are no textbooks that can make a person this kind of a leader. It must be learned by experience – Rom. 5:3-5.
- Leaders who have been through the fire themselves exemplify maturity in their character *(temperance, extra compassion for others, empathy, tolerance, etc.)* – Matt. 15:21-32; 20:30-34; 23:37; Luke 19:41-42.

#7 - World Vision – a consistently sanctified life

- All major principles of the Christian life have been learned, practiced, and tested – Php. 3:10.
- The disciple sees this world the way God sees it in every capacity – Gal. 6:14.

- The disciple knows what he/she is to do because they know God deeply.
- The disciple has a life that truly exemplifies being a stranger/pilgrim in this world – Heb. 11:13; 1 Pet. 2:11-12.

KEY The disciple is commissioned to reach the world and ***entirely expects*** to ***accomplish that mission***.

b. Summarizing this Process of Growth…

- Not everyone is called to vocational ministry *(pastor or missionary)*, but everyone is called to the ministry. **EVERYONE** can do something important for God. How this calling works out practically in the lives of people will differ. However, **EVERY** believer is designed to come through this process successfully. God gave us a Book with everything we need and placed His Holy Spirit inside us at the moment of salvation. There is no excuse.

KEY "**WALKING** with God" is not always the easiest journey, but it is the best journey with the best intentions of our great God always at work – Rom. 8:28! God promises to always walk with us through all things – Heb. 13:5!

WALKING WITH GOD



MBC – "Next Steps" Bible Study

The Goal of this Series

To teach the Bible Believer the basics of his past, present, and future relationship to Jesus Christ *in order to have victory over sin and bring glory to God on a daily basis*.

Some of the issues we will deal with in this series are as follows:

1. The nature and condition of mankind
2. The enemies of a Believer and the ensuing warfare that is encountered
3. Living a life of Victory
4. Justification and sanctification
5. Spiritual development and reproduction

Key Text: Galatians 5:25

Galatians 5:25 - *"If we **live** in the Spirit, let us also **walk** in the Spirit."*

Week 1

Introduction

1. The Spiritual Christian

Our salvation introduced us to an intense struggle for true, biblical spirituality. A battle now exists between our flesh and our spirit *(Galatians 5:17)*.

KEY This battle ***cannot be won*** by suppressing the desires of the flesh through our own willpower. (2 Corinthians 10:3-5; Romans 8:13)

Yet, God made us to have **VICTORY** over the flesh. Unfortunately, many believers seem to be losing that battle. As in any warfare there must be an equipping with the proper weapons, accompanied by ample training to use them.

We will seek to accomplish this "equipping and training" in order to achieve the overall goal of this series.

As we begin our study, let's consider some Biblical facts about our relationship with God:

a. We must allow God's truth to **TRANSFORM** us, not merely inform us – Philippians 4:9; James 1:21-25

NOTE *Informed* = Learned, Received, Heard, Seen

Transformed = **CHANGED** in form…*and the God of peace shall be with you.*

b. Spirituality is not determined by what we do for God, but rather, it is who we are **WITH** God – Genesis 3:8, 5:21-24; Hebrews 11:5; Rev. 2:2-5

NOTE A real, truly Biblical Christian is one who doesn't just do all the right things, but one who knows God! Superficiality breaks down eventually. One who is truly spiritual is changed from deep within and it then works its way out!

c. True Biblical spirituality is determined by our **DESIRE** to know God and to have an intimate relationship with Him – Mark 14:18-19; John 13:21-25; Luke 10:38-42; Philippians 3:8-10; James 4:8

NOTE Knowing God is what this is all about…

d. The desire to know Him was placed in our hearts at salvation and is made operative by the **HOLY SPIRIT** – Romans 8:15; Galatians 4:6

NOTE The Holy Spirit lives inside of us. You can't get more intimate than that! Yet, we don't often think of it in these terms.

e. It is possible to quench and **GRIEVE** the working of God's Spirit within us – 1 Thessalonians 5:19; Ephesians 4:25-30

f. Many have pointed out this progression, where we grieve the Spirit of God, this is the internal conviction when we sin. And, when we continue to do this, we quench (put out the fire/conviction/etc..) the Spirit of God.

g. When we stop feeling conviction, BEWARE! This is a dangerous spot for us to be in!

h. When we are quenching the Spirit, we are not "feeding" the Spirit, we are putting it out by our works of the flesh!

NOTE Because He is so close to us…because He is Holy…our sin and our apathy hurts Him!

f. Walking by faith and not by sight ... becoming a Biblically spiritual Christian is a **CHOICE** – Hebrews 11:23-26; Daniel 3:16-18

NOTE At some point in our Christian life, we must wake up to the realization that we make ***critical choices daily*** for God's glory or for our own.

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